BASIC CYBERSECURITY POLICY

Document Owner: IT Department
Organisation: Example Small Organisation
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Review Frequency: Annually

1. Purpose

This policy aims to protect the organisation's data, devices, accounts, and systems from cybersecurity threats. It establishes basic security rules for passwords, devices, email, and incident reporting.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees, interns, contractors, and authorised users. It covers organisational devices, accounts, networks, email, and information used for work, including remote work.

3. Password and Account Security

- Use strong, unique passwords for work accounts.
- Enable multi-factor authentication (MFA) wherever available.
- Never share passwords or authentication codes.
- Store passwords securely using an approved password manager.
- Report suspected account compromise immediately.

4. Device and Equipment Security

- Lock devices when unattended.
- Install security updates promptly.

- Use approved antivirus and software.
- Avoid unknown USB drives and suspicious downloads.
- Report lost or stolen devices immediately.
- Use personal devices for work only when authorised.

5. Email and Internet Security

- Verify suspicious emails and sender addresses.
- Avoid unexpected attachments and suspicious links.
- Never share confidential information with unauthorised people.
- Use approved websites, applications, and file-sharing services.
- Verify unusual payment or sensitive-information requests.
- Report suspected phishing emails promptly.

6. Incident Reporting and Response

Employees must promptly report cybersecurity incidents to the IT department or their manager.

Examples include phishing emails, stolen devices, malware, unauthorised access, and data leaks.

Employees must:

- Report incidents immediately.
- Avoid suspicious links and attachments.
- Preserve relevant evidence.
- Follow instructions from authorised personnel.

The organisation must investigate incidents, limit damage, restore affected systems securely, and document the actions taken.

7. Employee Responsibilities

All employees and authorised users must:

- Follow the organisation's cybersecurity policy.
- Protect passwords, devices, and confidential information.
- Use approved software and services for work.
- Complete required security awareness training.
- Report suspicious activities and security incidents promptly.

- Cooperate with authorised security investigations.

8. Policy Violations

Failure to follow this policy may result in appropriate disciplinary action, depending on the seriousness of the violation and applicable organisational rules.

All suspected violations must be reported to the appropriate manager or designated IT/security contact.

The organisation will review reported violations fairly and take corrective action where necessary.

9. Policy Review and Approval

This policy must be reviewed annually or whenever significant security changes occur.

Management is responsible for reviewing and approving the policy. Employees must be informed of any updates.